

NCIE Monitoring & Evaluation Framework

NCIE MONITORING & EVALUATION FRAMEWORK

National Council for Innovation & Entrepreneurship (NCIE)

Framework Area: Programme Monitoring, Evaluation, Performance Management & Impact Assessment

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1. INTRODUCTION

The **NCIE Monitoring & Evaluation (M&E) Framework** provides a structured system for monitoring programme implementation, measuring performance, evaluating outcomes and assessing the impact of NCIE initiatives.

The framework is applicable across NCIE programmes relating to **innovation, entrepreneurship, skill development, AI and digital technologies, leadership, student development, institutional capacity building, incubation, startup development, Government and institutional collaboration, CSR-supported programmes and other eligible initiatives.**

The M&E framework is designed to ensure that programmes are:

- Properly planned
 - Effectively implemented
 - Regularly monitored
 - Measurably evaluated
 - Properly documented
 - Continuously improved
 - Focused on beneficiary outcomes and impact
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2. PURPOSE OF THE FRAMEWORK

The M&E Framework aims to establish a systematic mechanism for:

- Tracking programme implementation.
- Measuring achievement against approved objectives.

- Monitoring beneficiary participation.
 - Assessing programme quality.
 - Measuring outputs and outcomes.
 - Identifying implementation gaps.
 - Supporting evidence-based decision-making.
 - Improving programme effectiveness.
 - Monitoring resource utilisation.
 - Measuring institutional development.
 - Tracking innovation and startup progression.
 - Assessing social and economic impact.
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3. M&E PRINCIPLES

NCIE monitoring and evaluation shall be guided by:

Transparency

Programme performance should be supported by appropriate records and evidence.

Accountability

Programme teams should remain responsible for agreed deliverables.

Evidence-Based Assessment

Performance should be assessed using verifiable information wherever practical.

Outcome Orientation

Monitoring should move beyond activity counting towards measurable outcomes.

Continuous Improvement

Monitoring findings should be used to improve programme design and implementation.

Inclusiveness

Beneficiary participation and access should be appropriately monitored.

Data Integrity

Programme information should be accurate, consistent and appropriately managed.

Compliance

Monitoring and reporting should follow applicable programme, funding and institutional requirements.

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4. M&E LOGIC MODEL

NCIE programmes may be monitored through the following results chain:

INPUTS



ACTIVITIES



OUTPUTS



OUTCOMES



IMPACT

Inputs

Resources invested in the programme.

Examples:

- Financial resources
- Human resources
- Trainers
- Mentors
- Technology
- Infrastructure
- Partnerships

Activities

Actions undertaken under the programme.

Examples:

- Training
- Workshops
- Mentoring
- Hackathons
- Innovation challenges
- Institutional activities
- Startup support

Outputs

Immediate measurable deliverables.

Examples:

- Participants trained
- Sessions conducted
- Institutions onboarded
- Projects developed
- Mentorship sessions completed

Outcomes

Changes resulting from programme participation.

Examples:

- Improved skills
- Increased innovation capability
- Improved entrepreneurial readiness
- Ideas validated
- Startups progressed
- Institutional capacity strengthened

Impact

Longer-term contribution.

Examples:

- Innovation ecosystem development

- Enterprise creation
- Employment-related outcomes where verifiable
- Institutional transformation
- Social and economic contribution

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5. M&E FRAMEWORK

The overall monitoring system follows:

PLAN

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IMPLEMENT

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MONITOR

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VERIFY

↓

EVALUATE

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REPORT

↓

IMPROVE

↓

SCALE

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6. MONITORING LEVELS

NCIE may conduct monitoring at multiple levels.

Level 1 – Participant Monitoring

Tracking:

- Registration
- Attendance
- Participation
- Course completion
- Assessments
- Certification

Level 2 – Programme Monitoring

Tracking:

- Activities
- Sessions
- Trainers
- Mentors
- Outputs
- Timelines
- Programme quality

Level 3 – Institutional Monitoring

Tracking:

- Institutions onboarded
- Institutional activities
- Innovation infrastructure
- Faculty participation
- Student engagement
- Institutional outcomes

Level 4 – Project Monitoring

Tracking:

- Project milestones
- Innovation projects

- Startup development
- Prototype progress
- Funding utilisation where applicable

Level 5 – Impact Monitoring

Assessing:

- Outcomes
 - Sustainability
 - Innovation results
 - Enterprise progression
 - Social and economic impact
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7. KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS (KPIs)

NCIE may establish programme-specific KPIs covering:

Participation

- Registrations
- Active participants
- Attendance rate
- Completion rate

Training

- Training sessions
- Training hours
- Participants trained
- Certification rate

Innovation

- Ideas submitted
- Innovation projects
- Prototypes developed
- Projects validated

Entrepreneurship

- Entrepreneurship participants
- Business concepts developed
- Startups formed
- Startups supported

Institutional Development

- Institutions onboarded
- Innovation centres supported
- Innovation labs established
- Faculty trained

Partnerships

- Academic partners
- Industry partners
- CSR partners
- Knowledge partners
- Ecosystem partners

Impact

- Skill improvement
- Innovation progression
- Startup progression
- Institutional capability improvement
- Employment or enterprise outcomes where verifiable

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8. OUTPUT INDICATORS

Output indicators measure direct programme deliverables.

Examples include:

Programme Area	Indicative Output Indicators
Training	Participants trained, sessions conducted
Internship	Interns enrolled, projects completed
Innovation	Ideas submitted, projects developed

Hackathons	Teams participating, solutions presented
Entrepreneurship	Participants trained, business concepts developed
Mentorship	Mentorship sessions, mentees supported
Incubation	Startups/incubation projects supported
Institution Development	Institutions onboarded, facilities supported
Faculty Development	Faculty trained, workshops completed
Scholarships	Beneficiaries supported, scholarships processed

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9. OUTCOME INDICATORS

Outcome indicators measure changes resulting from programme participation.

Potential indicators include:

- Improvement in participant knowledge.
- Improvement in technical skills.
- Improvement in digital capability.
- Improvement in entrepreneurial readiness.
- Increased innovation capability.
- Successful idea validation.
- Prototype development.
- Startup progression.
- Increased institutional innovation activity.
- Increased industry engagement.
- Improved mentoring access.

Where outcomes are reported, appropriate evidence should be maintained.

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10. IMPACT INDICATORS

Longer-term impact may be assessed through:

Economic Impact

- Enterprise development
- Startup progression
- Employment-related outcomes where verifiable
- Entrepreneurial activity

Educational Impact

- Student capability development
- Faculty capacity building
- Institutional innovation activity

Innovation Impact

- Solutions developed
- Prototypes
- Technology adoption
- Innovation projects progressing towards implementation

Social Impact

- Beneficiary reach
- Inclusion
- Community-oriented innovation
- Youth participation

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11. BASELINE & TARGET SETTING

Where appropriate, programmes should establish:

Baseline

Existing condition before programme intervention.

Target

Expected level of achievement.

Actual

Measured result achieved.

Variance

Difference between target and actual performance.

Example:

Target: 1,000 participants

Actual: 920 participants

Achievement: 92%

This allows programme managers to identify performance gaps and corrective actions.

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12. PROGRAMME MONITORING CYCLE

NCIE may use:

Daily / Session-Level Monitoring

- Attendance
- Trainer activity
- Session completion
- Participant engagement

Monthly Monitoring

- Programme progress
- KPI achievement
- Institutional participation
- Resource utilisation

Quarterly Review

- Output achievement
- Outcome progress
- Financial performance
- Partner performance
- Implementation challenges

Annual Evaluation

- Programme effectiveness
- Outcome achievement
- Impact
- Sustainability
- Future programme requirements

The actual frequency may vary according to programme size and funding requirements.

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13. DIGITAL MONITORING & MIS

NCIE may maintain a digital **Management Information System (MIS)** to support:

- Registration
- Attendance
- Participant tracking
- Institution tracking
- Programme activity
- Certification
- Trainer management
- Mentor management
- KPI monitoring
- Project tracking
- Funding tracking
- Reporting

The MIS may provide dashboards for authorised programme-management personnel.

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14. BENEFICIARY TRACKING

Participant-level information may include, as appropriate:

- Registration details
- Institution

- Programme
- Participation
- Attendance
- Assessment
- Completion
- Certification
- Innovation/project participation
- Mentorship
- Startup progression

Data collection should follow applicable privacy, consent and institutional requirements.

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15. ATTENDANCE MONITORING

Depending on delivery mode, attendance may be recorded through:

Online

- Digital attendance
- Learning-platform participation
- Session records

Offline

- Physical attendance
- Institutional attendance records
- Programme registers

Hybrid

- Combined digital and physical records.

Attendance requirements should be defined according to the specific programme.

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16. TRAINING & LEARNING ASSESSMENT

Where applicable, learning effectiveness may be assessed through:

- Pre-assessment
- Post-assessment
- Assignments
- Projects
- Presentations
- Practical activities
- Participant feedback

Learning Improvement

Where comparable assessments are used:

PRE-PROGRAMME PERFORMANCE

→

TRAINING

→

POST-PROGRAMME PERFORMANCE

→

LEARNING GAIN

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17. INNOVATION PROJECT MONITORING

Innovation projects may be monitored through milestones such as:

IDEA

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PROBLEM DEFINITION

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SOLUTION DESIGN

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PROTOTYPE

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TESTING



VALIDATION



PRESENTATION



IMPLEMENTATION / INCUBATION

This framework may be adapted to individual programme requirements.



18. STARTUP PROGRESSION MONITORING

Selected startup initiatives may be tracked through:

- Idea stage
- Validation
- Prototype
- Product development
- Market testing
- Business model
- Incubation
- Investor readiness
- Investment discussions
- Scale-up

Investor discussions should not be recorded as investment unless investment has actually been formally committed or completed.



19. INSTITUTIONAL PERFORMANCE MONITORING

Participating institutions may be monitored against:

- Programme participation
- Student engagement
- Faculty participation

- Innovation activities
 - Entrepreneurship activities
 - Industry interaction
 - Innovation infrastructure
 - Startup activity
 - Institutional outcomes
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20. PARTNERSHIP PERFORMANCE MONITORING

Partnerships may be reviewed using:

- Agreed deliverables
 - Activities completed
 - Resources contributed
 - Beneficiary reach
 - Programme outcomes
 - Reporting compliance
 - Partner participation
 - Sustainability
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21. FINANCIAL MONITORING

Where applicable, financial monitoring may include:

- Approved budget
- Expenditure
- Balance
- Budget variance
- Resource utilisation
- Project-wise expenditure
- Funding-source restrictions
- Supporting documentation

Financial monitoring should remain aligned with applicable funding agreements and internal financial controls.

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22. DATA QUALITY & VERIFICATION

NCIE may establish procedures for:

- Data validation
- Duplicate detection
- Record verification
- Attendance verification
- Beneficiary verification
- Document verification
- Periodic data review

Where programme claims are published, appropriate supporting evidence should be maintained.

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23. FIELD & INSTITUTIONAL VERIFICATION

Where programmes involve physical implementation, monitoring may include:

- Institutional visits
- Programme observations
- Beneficiary interaction
- Document verification
- Activity verification
- Infrastructure verification
- Photographic documentation where appropriate

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24. PARTICIPANT FEEDBACK

Feedback may be collected regarding:

- Programme quality
- Trainers
- Mentors
- Curriculum
- Digital platform
- Learning experience

- Institutional support
- Programme relevance

Feedback may be used to improve future programme delivery.

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25. GRIEVANCE & FEEDBACK MECHANISM

Participants and institutional partners may be provided appropriate channels for:

- Complaints
- Suggestions
- Programme-related issues
- Certification issues
- Registration issues
- Attendance concerns
- Institutional concerns

Complaints should be appropriately recorded and addressed through the designated mechanism.

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26. EVALUATION METHODS

Depending on programme requirements, evaluation may use:

- Quantitative indicators
- Qualitative assessment
- Participant surveys
- Pre/post assessments
- Interviews
- Focus-group discussions
- Case studies
- Institutional reviews
- Project evaluations
- Outcome tracking

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27. MID-TERM REVIEW

For longer-duration programmes, an interim review may assess:

- Progress against targets
- Implementation quality
- Resource utilisation
- Beneficiary participation
- Emerging challenges
- Corrective requirements

Findings may be used to modify implementation where appropriate.

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28. END-OF-PROGRAMME EVALUATION

Programme completion evaluation may assess:

- Objectives achieved
- Outputs delivered
- Outcomes achieved
- Beneficiary satisfaction
- Resource utilisation
- Implementation efficiency
- Challenges
- Sustainability
- Lessons learned

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29. IMPACT ASSESSMENT

Impact assessment may examine whether programme interventions have contributed to longer-term changes.

Potential areas:

STUDENT DEVELOPMENT



SKILL DEVELOPMENT



INNOVATION CAPABILITY



ENTREPRENEURIAL CAPABILITY



STARTUP DEVELOPMENT



INSTITUTIONAL STRENGTHENING



SOCIAL & ECONOMIC CONTRIBUTION

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30. REPORTING FRAMEWORK

NCIE may prepare:

- Session reports
- Monthly reports
- Quarterly progress reports
- Annual programme reports
- Project completion reports
- Financial reports
- Partner reports
- Impact reports

Reporting requirements may be adapted according to the specific programme and funding agreement.

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31. M&E REPORTING STRUCTURE

A standard programme report may include:

1. Programme overview
2. Objectives
3. Activities completed
4. Beneficiary details
5. Attendance
6. KPI performance
7. Output achievement
8. Outcome progress
9. Financial status, where applicable
10. Challenges
11. Corrective actions
12. Success stories
13. Evidence
14. Lessons learned
15. Recommendations

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32. PERFORMANCE DASHBOARD

An NCIE programme dashboard may monitor:

Indicator	Targ et	Actu al	Achievem ent	Stat us
Participants	—	—	—	—
Institutions	—	—	—	—
Training Sessions	—	—	—	—
Innovation Projects	—	—	—	—
Mentorship Sessions	—	—	—	—
Startups Supported	—	—	—	—
Partnerships	—	—	—	—

Actual targets should be determined separately for each programme.

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33. CORRECTIVE ACTION MECHANISM

Where performance falls below agreed targets:

PERFORMANCE GAP



CAUSE ANALYSIS



CORRECTIVE ACTION PLAN



RESPONSIBLE PERSON / TEAM



TIMELINE



FOLLOW-UP



REASSESSMENT

This enables continuous programme improvement.

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34. SUCCESS STORY & CASE STUDY FRAMEWORK

Selected programme outcomes may be documented through case studies covering:

- Beneficiary background
- Initial situation
- Programme intervention
- Skills or support received
- Innovation/project development
- Outcome

- Evidence
- Longer-term progression

Case studies should be published only with appropriate permissions and factual verification.

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35. RISK-BASED MONITORING

Higher-risk programmes or projects may receive enhanced monitoring based on:

- Programme scale
- Funding value
- Geographic coverage
- Implementation complexity
- Number of beneficiaries
- Partner complexity
- Regulatory requirements

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36. INDEPENDENT EVALUATION

Where appropriate, significant programmes may be subjected to independent evaluation by qualified external experts or organisations.

Independent evaluation may be particularly useful for:

- Large-scale programmes
- Multi-year projects
- CSR-supported programmes
- Institutional development initiatives
- Programmes requiring formal impact assessment

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37. M&E GOVERNANCE

The monitoring structure may include:

NCIE GOVERNANCE / AUTHORISED MANAGEMENT



PROGRAMME MANAGEMENT



M&E / MONITORING FUNCTION



STATE / REGIONAL / DISTRICT COORDINATION



INSTITUTIONAL NODAL PERSON



TRAINERS / MENTORS / FIELD TEAMS



BENEFICIARY DATA & PROGRAMME RECORDS

Roles shall be defined according to the size and nature of each programme.

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38. M&E RESPONSIBILITIES

Programme Management

- Define programme targets.
- Monitor implementation.
- Review performance.
- Take corrective action.

M&E Function

- Develop indicators.
- Collect and analyse data.
- Maintain monitoring reports.
- Verify performance information.

Institutional Coordinators

- Maintain participation records.
- Support beneficiary verification.
- Report institutional activities.

Trainers & Mentors

- Record session delivery.
- Assess participant progress.
- Provide feedback.

Finance Function

- Monitor approved budgets.
- Track expenditure.
- Maintain financial documentation.

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39. M&E DATA FLOW

BENEFICIARY / INSTITUTION



PROGRAMME TEAM



DIGITAL / PHYSICAL RECORD



M&E SYSTEM



DATA VALIDATION



KPI DASHBOARD



MANAGEMENT REVIEW



CORRECTIVE ACTION



PROGRAMME REPORT



40. ANNUAL PROGRAMME REVIEW

An annual review may consider:

- Programme performance
- Beneficiary reach
- KPI achievement
- Output and outcome results
- Financial performance
- Partnership performance
- Impact
- Risks
- Sustainability
- Lessons learned

The review may inform the next year's programme planning and resource allocation.



41. M&E DOCUMENTATION & EVIDENCE

Programme evidence may include:

- Registration records
- Attendance
- Assessment records
- Certificates
- Project reports
- Photographs
- Videos
- Institutional records
- Financial records

- Utilisation documentation
- Partner reports
- Feedback forms
- Impact studies

Documentation should be retained according to applicable organisational, legal and funding requirements.

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42. DATA PRIVACY & RESPONSIBLE USE

Beneficiary information should be collected and processed responsibly.

Appropriate safeguards should cover:

- Consent where required
- Data minimisation
- Access control
- Confidentiality
- Secure storage
- Responsible sharing
- Retention and disposal

Personal information should not be publicly disclosed unnecessarily.

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43. CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT FRAMEWORK

NCIE may follow:

MONITOR

→ **ANALYSE**

→ **LEARN**

→ **IMPROVE**

→ **IMPLEMENT**

→ **RE-MONITOR**

This creates a continuous programme improvement cycle.

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44. M&E MATURITY MODEL

NCIE's monitoring systems may progressively develop through:

Stage 1 – Activity Monitoring

Tracking whether activities occurred.

Stage 2 – Output Monitoring

Measuring immediate programme results.

Stage 3 – Outcome Monitoring

Measuring changes among beneficiaries.

Stage 4 – Impact Assessment

Assessing longer-term effects.

Stage 5 – Evidence-Based Programme Management

Using data and evaluation findings to continuously improve programme design and resource allocation.

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45. OVERALL RESULTS FRAMEWORK

NCIE programmes follow the broader pathway:

RESOURCES

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ACTIVITIES

↓

OUTPUTS

↓

OUTCOMES

↓

IMPACT

with the continuous cycle:

MONITOR → EVALUATE → LEARN → IMPROVE → SCALE

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46. FRAMEWORK STATEMENT

The NCIE Monitoring & Evaluation Framework provides a systematic and outcome-oriented mechanism for tracking programme implementation, measuring performance, assessing outputs and outcomes, documenting evidence and evaluating the longer-term contribution of NCIE initiatives.

The framework is intended to strengthen transparency, accountability, programme quality and continuous improvement across NCIE's innovation, entrepreneurship, skill development, leadership, technology, institutional development and youth-focused initiatives.

NCIE M&E PATHWAY

**PLAN → IMPLEMENT → MONITOR → VERIFY → EVALUATE
→ REPORT → IMPROVE → IMPACT**

The ultimate objective of the framework is to ensure that NCIE programmes are implemented in a structured manner and that programme decisions are increasingly informed by measurable evidence, beneficiary outcomes and demonstrated impact.